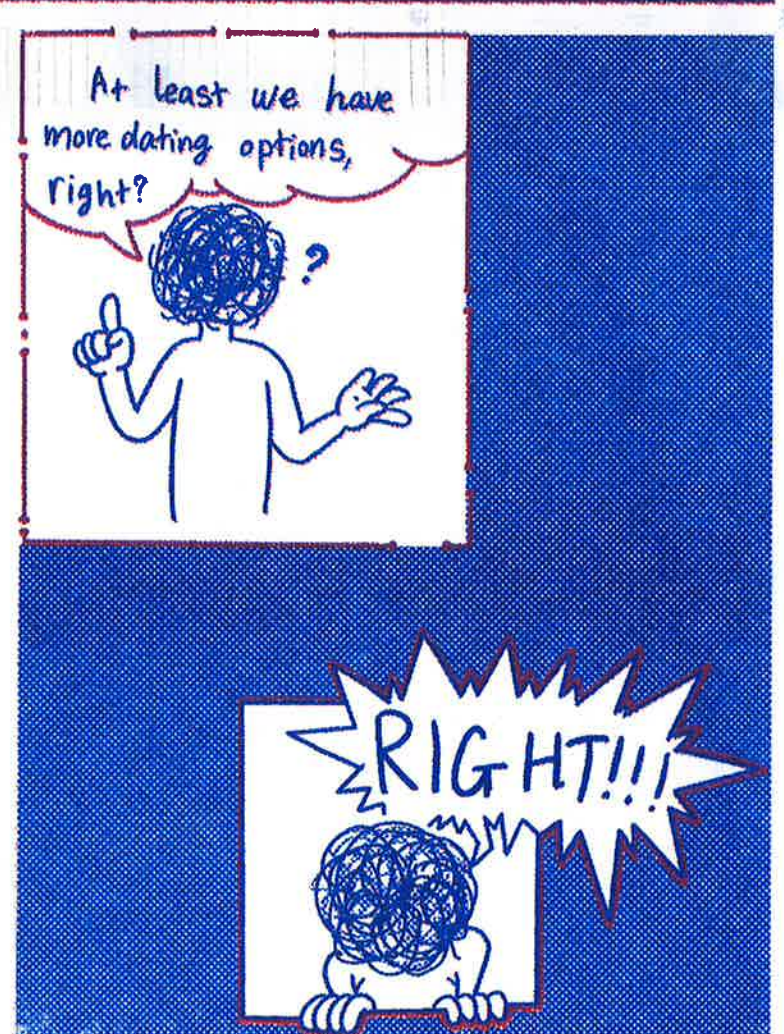
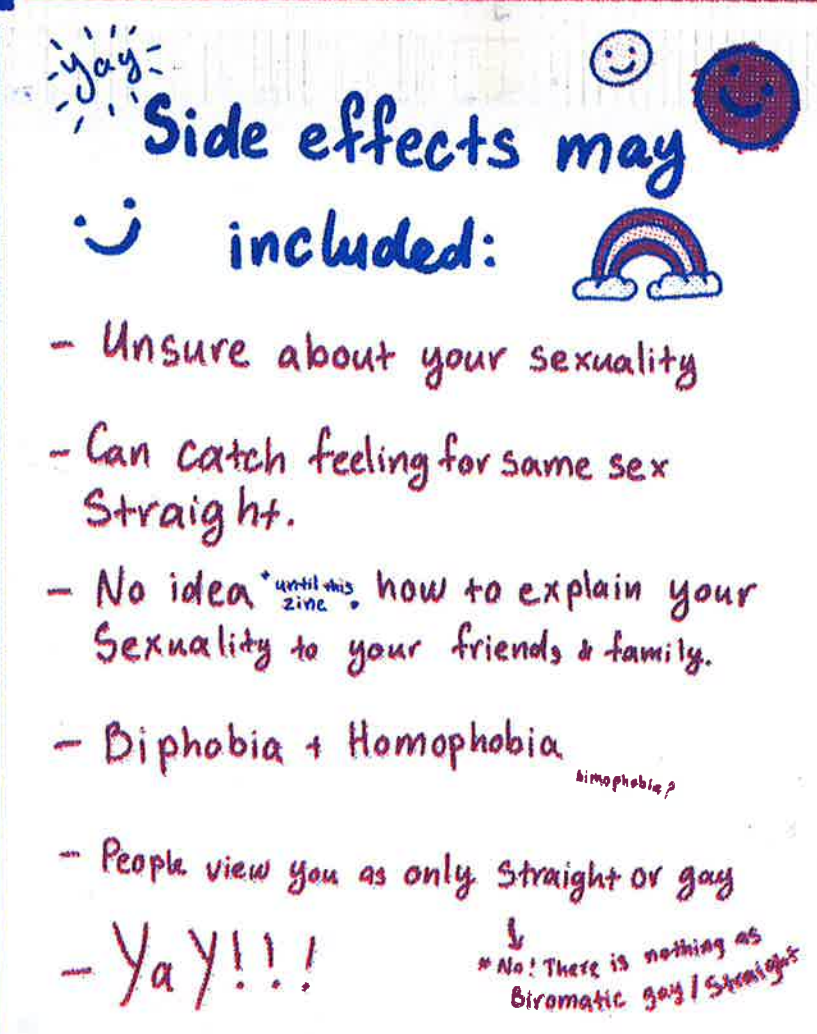
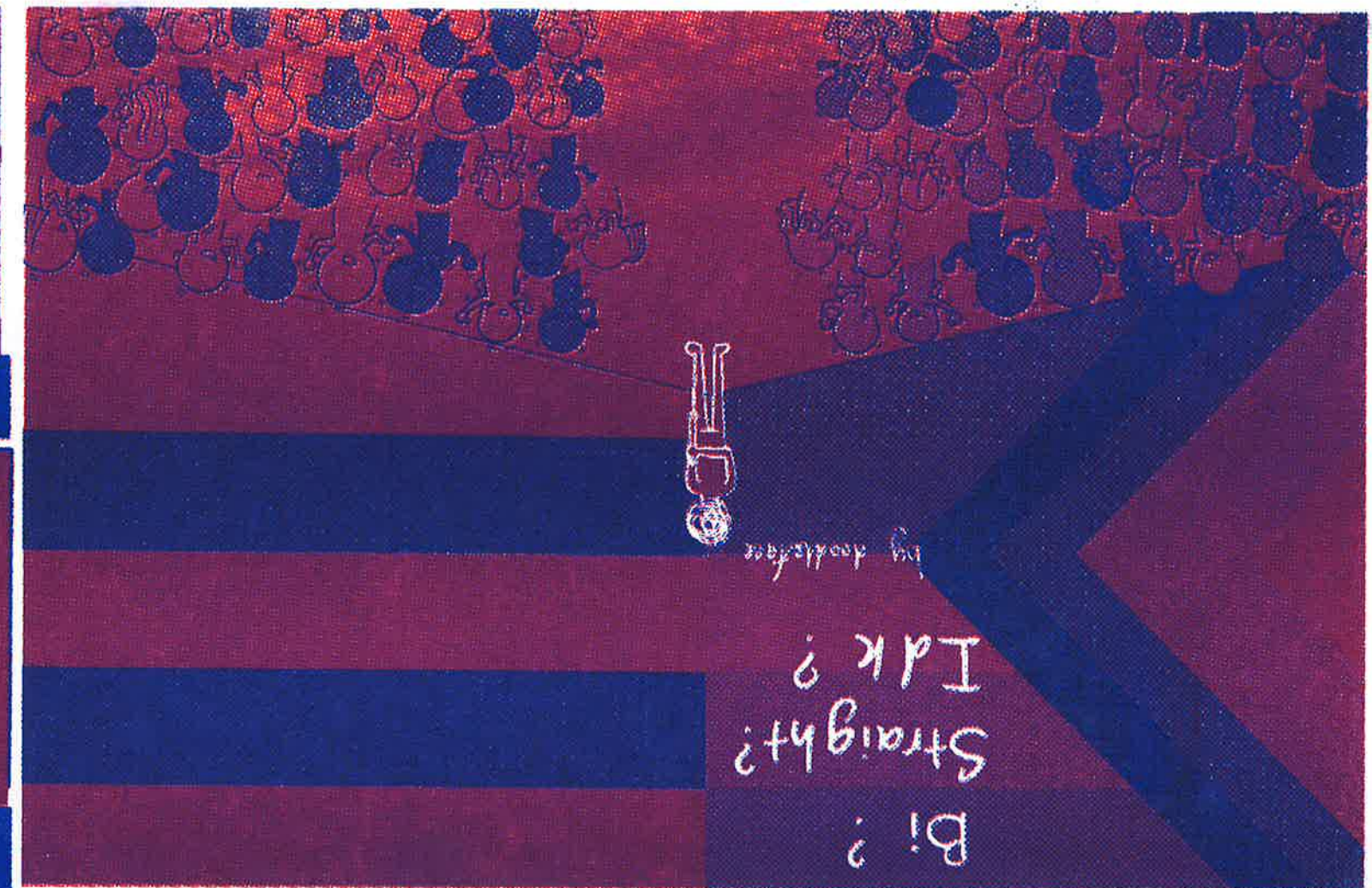
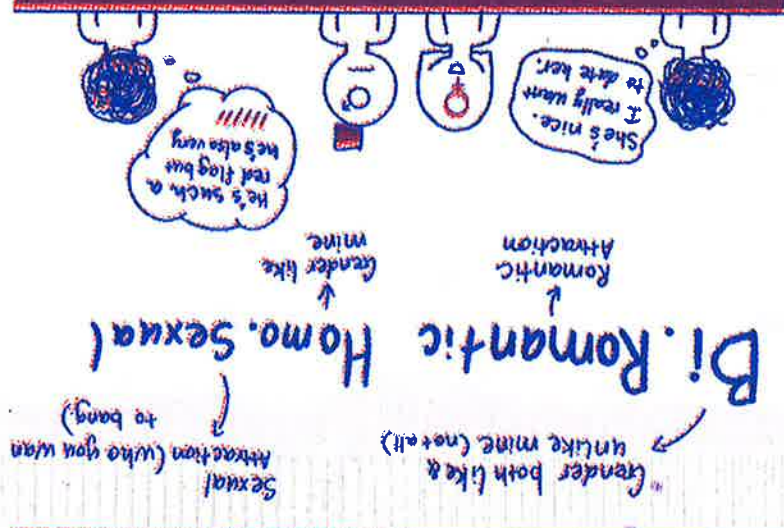
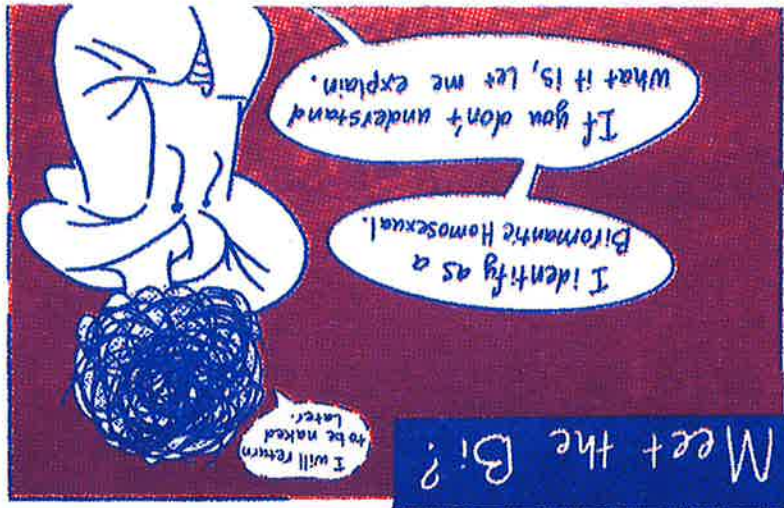






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Duc Nguyen

### Artist research statement Group

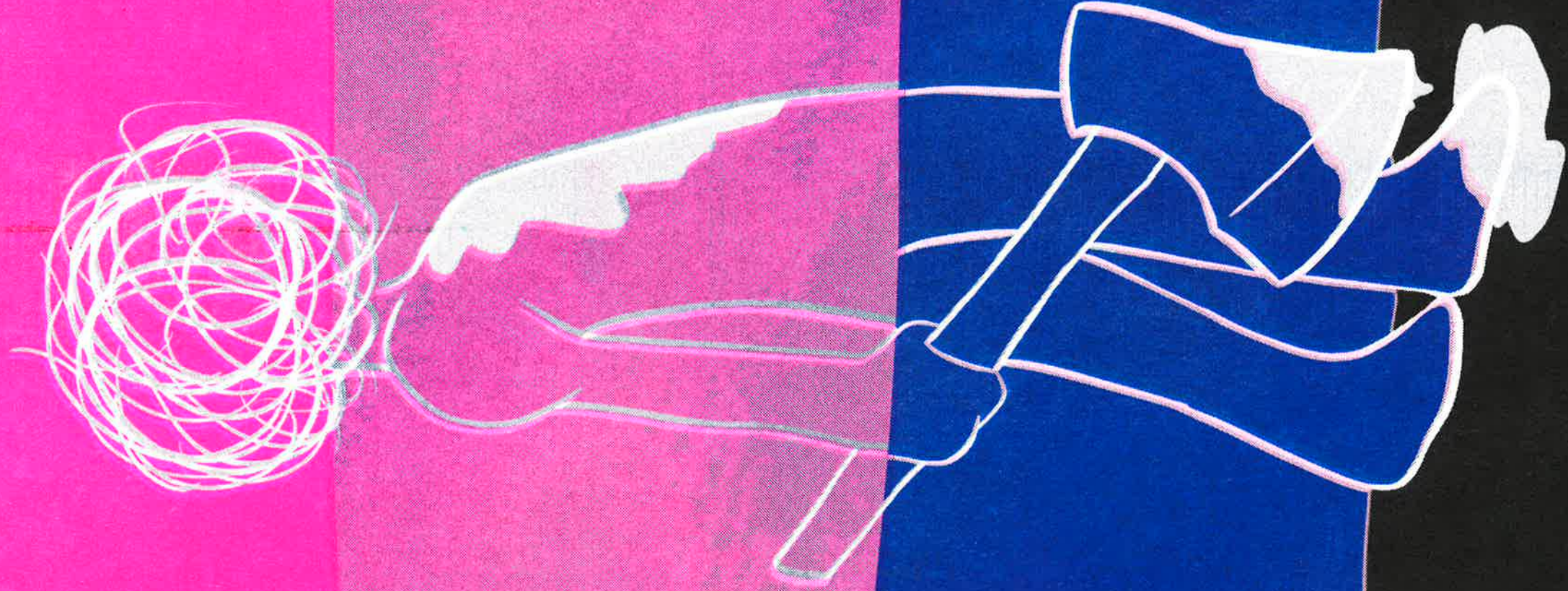
Looking back into the perspective of Group, I want to create a poster and pins that reflect the three core values that lie under the Group perspective: Collaboration, Common Purpose, and Controversy with Civility. I understand that my posters and pins might not be able to tackle all three equally, but I still want to include all of them to the best of my ability. My works are two different design posters and one pin design. I printed seven 11x17 posters and two enlarged ones for the first poster design. The second poster design will be three 11x17 posters. Finally, I create pins that go alongside the posters I create.

In this project, I want to explore my design skill while still keeping up with the styles from my previous project. Here, I try to keep my first and second project fit with each other through the color palette, humor, and sarcastic tone company my cartoonist drawing while adapting the dark black uneven border of the Pro Choice, Figh Rape, Fight Racism poster in Graphic Agitation 1 book. I also like how the poster centers the main image in the middle and uses multiple colors for its call to action. However, their choice of color for the poster words was different from what I wanted, so I decided to play with it more with my color palette.

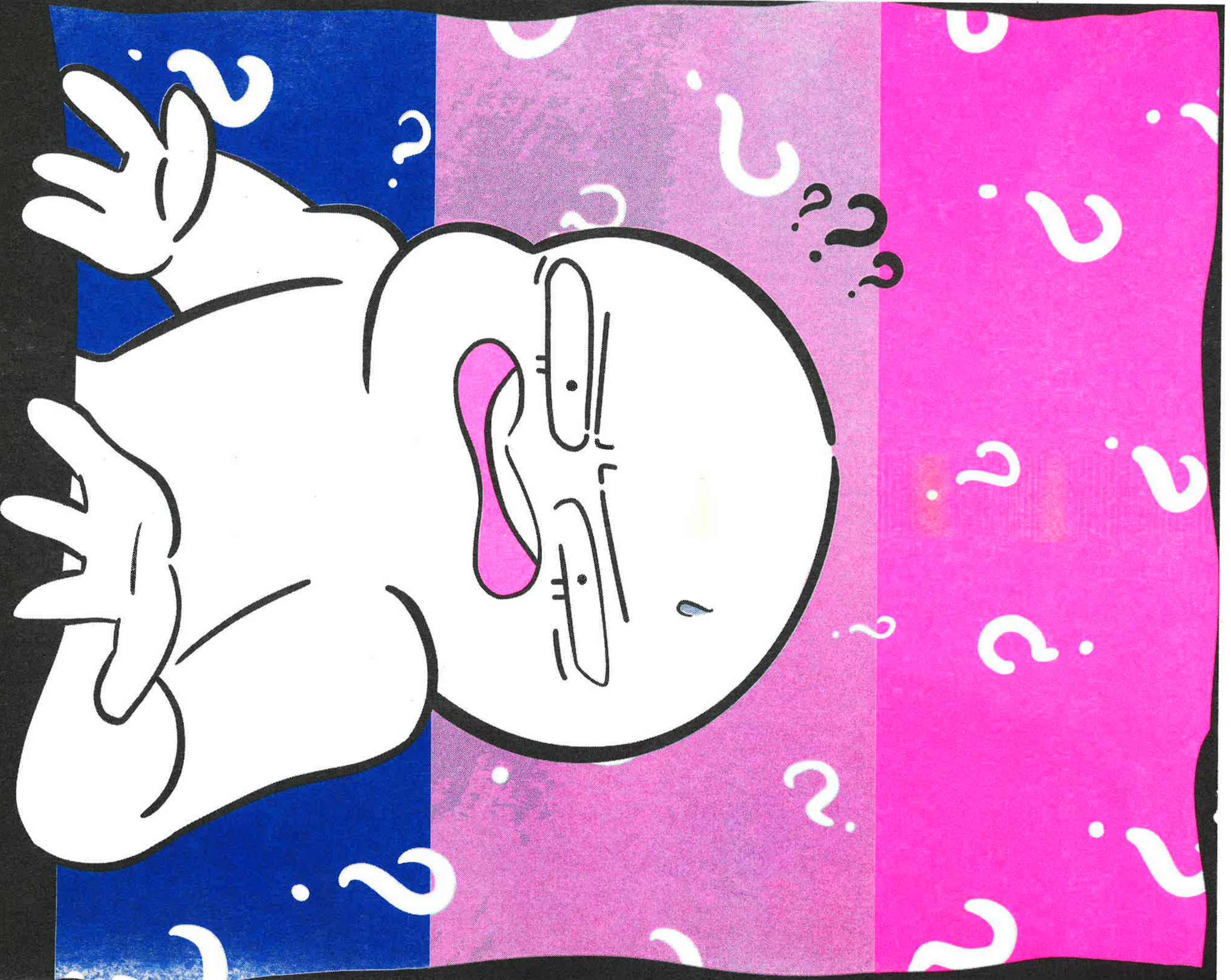
The first poster designs show how the Bi community should/are proud of their sexuality while comedically shaming other people's ignorance. The second one acts as an affirmation toward the Bi sexuality. Both use humor not as a way to humiliate something but as a way to show the Bi community is confident to make fun of our sexuality innocently. The humor is not about stereotypes of the Bi community but affirming our sexuality or telling people to educate themselves before speaking about the Bi community. Here, I want to show the Controversy with

Civility values through confrontation. In my first project, I already show my action to create a connection with other groups through personal experience. That is why in this project, I do not want to be "agreeable" with people rejecting Bisexuality. Despite recognizing different viewpoints toward sexuality, I want my posters to stand up and say that people need to be educated and accept that Bisexuality is valid, and no argument should be made that contradicts this.

With the pins that accompany the poster, I want to create something that keeps up with the poster's humorous tone and color palette while adding a different graphic to make them unique. While I understand the need to make the posters and the pins feel like they belong to each other, I also want my pins to be able to work as a separate entity that speaks for itself too. The pun is not just a humorous slogan but also acts to empower the Bisexuality community. The pins represent the Collaboration and the Common Purpose value, using its wearer to empower the Bi community. I use the phrase "Strong Bi-Fi" so people other than the Bi community can also wear it. The phrase is not telling people that its wearer is Bi, so they can make justifications if they want, but just suggesting someone near is Bi, so allies, families, or friends can also wear it to support their Bisexual "person."



My Axes Is like my  
Sexuality, Swinging  
Both Way



**Confused by your  
ignorance not my**

**Bisexuality**



Duc Nguyen

### Artist research statement Group

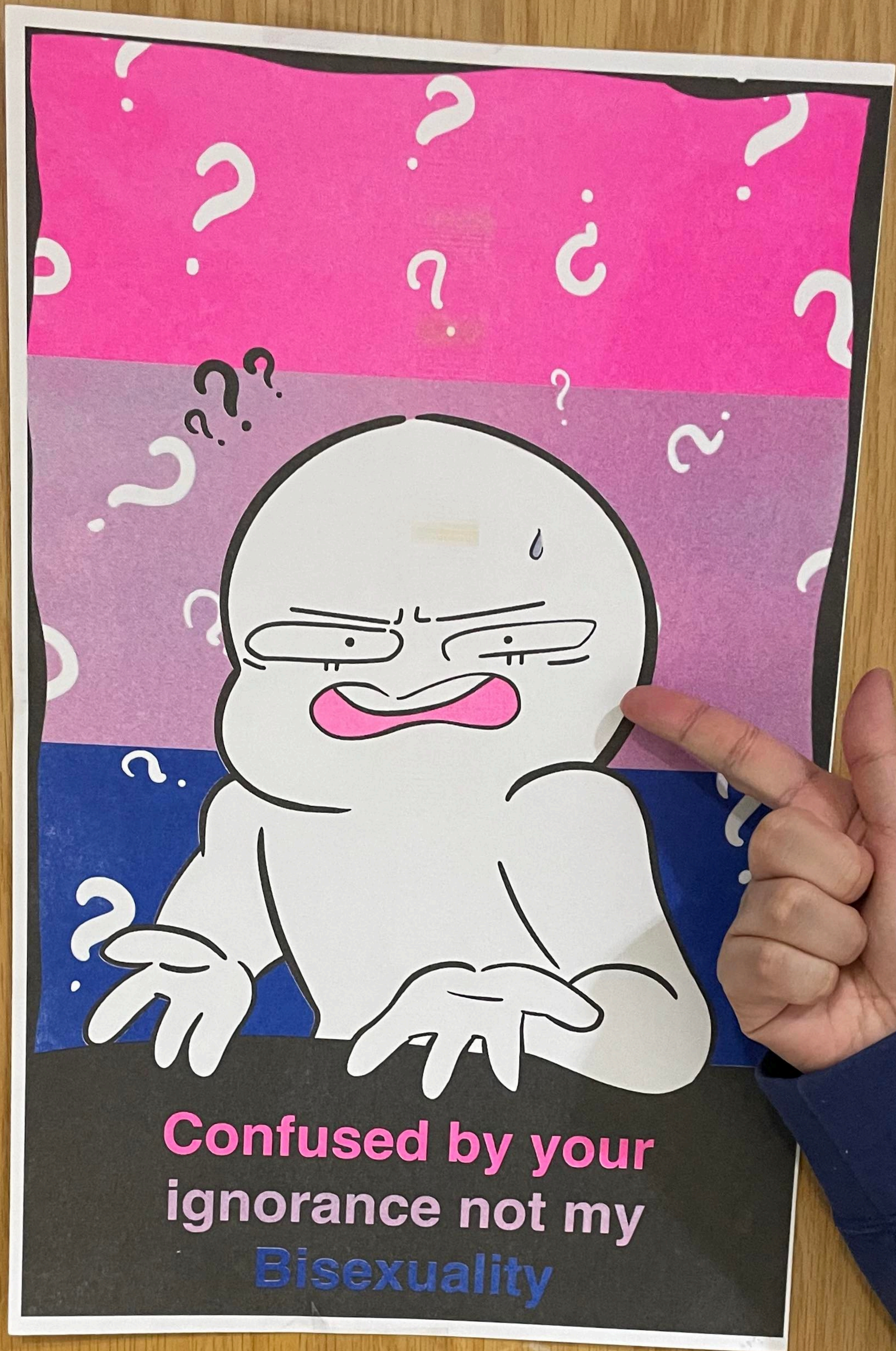
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Studio Art

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Duc Nguyen

### Project 3 Design Activism

In my project, I am designing a shirt that celebrates biromanticism as sexuality.

Biromanticism, which is less commonly known than bisexuality, refers to when a person is romantically attracted to people of two specific and distinct gender identities. Biromantic individuals may not be sexually attracted to the same people they're romantically attracted to, and they may identify as biromantic asexual, bisexual, heterosexual, homosexual, or pansexual.

As someone who identifies more as biromantic than bisexual, I am often frustrated by having to explain what biromanticism means. I want my shirt to help me express my identity without having to explain it to others constantly. To achieve this, I have included a bold QR code on the shirt that leads to the biromanticism definition page on WebMD. The message "Bi code Bitch" is a powerful statement that encourages people to scan the code and learn more about biromanticism. While the tone of the message may seem harsh, I see it as a way to demonstrate pride in my identity. I also want my shirt to be white and the design to have the Bi-color flag. Because I want this shirt can be worn by anyone, regardless of gender or sexual orientation. This is because people also often target and shame hetero-presenting relationships, which also damage the Bi community and non-queer presenting relationship. This inclusivity helps to break down the rigid boxes that society often places individuals and their partners in based on how society views them.

Shirts are a highly visible form of expression that can be worn anywhere, making them a powerful tool for communicating a message to a broad audience. According to Vogue, wearing a t-shirt turns the wearer into a walking billboard, and the message becomes part of their identity.

This can spark conversations and promote awareness in a personal and immediate way.

Additionally, shirts can express unity and solidarity to those who wear them, helping to create and empower communities.

Creating and empowering communities is a critical aspect of the Social Change Model of Leadership, where community falls under the categories of the model. Wearing a shirt is a small but meaningful way to support a community by spreading its message. I believe that my design should speak for its wearer, and shirts are a fantastic medium for this idea. This shirt is for people who feel like they have to hide under a recognizable term because they are tired of constantly explaining themselves. Scanning the QR code also shows unity and a willingness to learn from people, including those outside of the community. This helps create a safe space for people to explore and explain different aspects of themselves.

Ultimately, I hope that my shirt serves as a tool for people to express their sexuality and provide information to educate others. I also believe that my shirt can help build a community of support for those who wear it by demonstrating that there are people who are willing to learn and support them.

### Works Cited

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Remsen, Nick. "The Role of the T-Shirt in the Fight for Social Justice." *British Vogue*, 8 May 2021, <https://www.vogue.co.uk/fashion/article/power-of-t-shirts-for-activism>.

Duc Nguyen

Professor Taylor

Design Activism

08 Feb 2023

### Unit 1 Project

The idea I have for this project is all about opening one self to talk about one experience. My topic for this project is Biromantic Homosexual, where I create a zine to give people more information about what it is.

This topic I choose is very important to me because it is about my self-identity. I used to have no idea about what I was related to, and only until someone talked about Homoromantic Bisexual, then I figure there is more on the sexuality spectrum than just being Gay or Bi. Through this comic, I want kids who are also Biromantic don't struggle to find themselves as I did. This struggle to find myself, where I could feel right with my sexuality, gave me ideas to make this zine. Plus, the struggle to explain to people my sexuality also plays a massive role in making this zine.

In this zine, I want to give people information about Biromantic Homosexual without making the process feel like an encyclopedia. I always love reading webtoons and the way webtoon authors like Sarah Andersen or Obelis tackle serious issues with humor and wits. Their way of giving information makes the process much easier to absorb. This fits with Art and Social Justice Methods, which give people information to raise awareness and create a dialogue that helps with the lack of understanding. Using humor and personal experiences, I want to make all this information easy and fun while also feeling relatable.

The Zine color is a combination of Orchid, Blue, and Pink to recreate the Bi flag color. I want to hand-draw this zine plus combining with a halftone texture effect on the printings to make this comic-like. Also, the usage of negative space is what I want to explore, especially when the limitation of color is present. On the other side of the zine, I want to make something that feels personal while trying something uncomfortable. Although I never like capturing and putting my pictures, I still want to put something of myself out there. So to combat that fear of mine, I cover my face similar to the character in my zine.

In the end, I hope this zine can help with helping people who are still questioning their identity, whether they are Biromantic or not, and can find that they are not alone. I want this zine to help people not feel that they are alone on the journey of finding themselves. Furthermore, this zine will act as a tool to explain one part of the LGBTQ+ community that few people know of, so you can just give them to family members or friends who want to know more or just use them to make your homophobic family mad.

As we learn throughout our class, art can be a powerful tool for activism and social change. In my latest work for this project, I have created a flag that shows an image of a closet being opened with the message "Out of The Closet" written around it. This flag is a call to action, urging individuals who identify as LGBTQ+ to embrace their authentic selves and be open about their identities. Through this flag, I engage with art activism promoting LGBTQ+ visibility and acceptance.

The closet has long been a metaphor for the experience of hiding one's true identity, particularly in the LGBTQ+ community. For many individuals, coming out can be a difficult and complex process involving fear, uncertainty, and potential rejection from loved ones and society. Through my flag, I am seeking to challenge the stigma and fear associated with coming out and encourage individuals to embrace their true selves.

Flags have a unique power as a tool for activism. They are highly visible and can be displayed publicly, allowing messages to reach a wider audience. Unlike shirts, pins, and posters, flags have a significant and dramatic presence that can command attention and provoke conversation. They are versatile and can be hung in various settings, such as rallies, marches, and community events.

In addition, flags have a long history of being used as a symbol of resistance and solidarity. They have been used by oppressed and marginalized communities throughout history, from the suffragettes to the civil rights movement to the LGBTQ+ rights movement. By creating a flag that encourages individuals to come out of the closet, I am tapping into this tradition of using flags as a tool for social change and activism. This falls under the Group Value that we learn.

Where the flag acts as a tool to let people share one common purpose to recognize I also use the Bi color in the flag; despite the experience of "coming out" is not unique to the Bi community, I want this flag to target the Bi community specifically to tie in with my other project so far.

In conclusion, my flag is a powerful tool for activism and social change, urging individuals to embrace their authentic selves and come out of the closet. Through powerful imagery and a clear message, I hope to challenge the stigma and fear associated with coming out and promote LGBTQ+ visibility and acceptance. As an artist, my work can positively impact the world, and I will continue to use my art as a tool for activism and social change. By working towards a more just and equitable society, we can create a better future for all individuals, regardless of their identity.